

MATÍAS DENEKEN

Sociologist & Computational Social Scientist

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PROFILE

Sociologist and data scientist. My research examines violence, legitimacy, and political discourse using natural language processing, longitudinal survey data, and causal inference. I have held research positions at several national centres of excellence funded by Chile's Ministry of Science (ANID).

EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)

PhD in Computational Social Science

London, UK

2026 – Present

Data and Artificial Intelligence Center - UDEC

Master in Data Science and Innovation

Highest Distinction

Concepción, Chile

2024 – 2025

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

Master of Arts in Sociology

Highest Distinction

Santiago, Chile

2022 – 2023

Universidad de Concepción

Bachelor of Arts in Sociology

Highest Distinction

Concepción, Chile

2017 – 2021

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS & AWARDS

ANID International Doctoral Scholarship No. 72260034 — National Agency for Research and Development (ANID), Chile. Highly competitive national fellowship providing full funding for doctoral studies.

2026 – 2030

Fulbright Equal Opportunity Scholarship — Fulbright Commission & Ministry of Science, Chile. Full funding to pursue a PhD in the United States (from 2027); awarded for outstanding academic performance and research potential.

2024 – 2031

Declined

ANID National Master's Scholarship No. 22220115 — National Agency for Research and Development (ANID), Chile. Competitive national fellowship fully funding graduate study.

2022 – 2024

University of Concepción Award — Institutional distinction for outstanding academic excellence in the Sociology program.

2022

Best Sociology Student — Top-performing student of the Sociology cohort 2017–2021, University of Concepción.

2021

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Gerber, M. M., Castelo Branco, F., Cubas, V., Sáez-Fuentealba, L., de Oliveira, A. R., **Deneken, M.**, & Jackson, J. (in press). Fear of the police and the fragility of legitimacy: Insights from Chile and Brazil. *International Journal of Social Psychology*.

- Díaz, F., González, R., & **Deneken, M.** (accepted with major revisions). How intergroup contact and social norms shape outgroup trust over time among Indigenous and non-Indigenous people. *Political Psychology*.
- Alenda, S., Sandoval, C., Somma, N., & **Deneken, M.** (under review). Varieties of radical right discourse in Chile: A comparative analysis of José Antonio Kast and Johannes Kaiser. *Latin American Research Review*.
- **Deneken, M.** (2025). The brief history of the Center for the Study of National Reality, CEREN (1968–1973). *Revista Temas Sociológicos*, 37. [in Spanish]
- Maltrain, V., Cárdenas, J. C., Iglesias, M., & **Deneken, M.** (2023). “Camouflaged sociology” at ARCIS (1984–1991): Critique, commitment, and militancy. *Revista Izquierdas*, 52. [in Spanish]

Books & Edited Volumes

- **Deneken, M.**, & Valenzuela, E. (Eds.) (2025). *Radiografía del cambio intercultural en Chile: Dinámicas contemporáneas entre población indígena y no indígena*. Editorial Catalonia.

Book Chapters

- Valenzuela, E., & **Deneken, M.** (2025). El problema de la identificación indígena: Un análisis longitudinal. In **Deneken, M.** & Valenzuela, E. (Eds.), *(Re)configuraciones interculturales*. Editorial Catalonia.
- **Deneken, M.** (2025). Descifrando el voto de indígenas y no indígenas en Chile en el referéndum constitucional del 4 de septiembre de 2022: Un enfoque psicosocial. In **Deneken, M.** & Valenzuela, E. (Eds.), *(Re)configuraciones interculturales*. Editorial Catalonia.
- **Deneken, M.** (2023). An exonerated story: The Center for the Study of National Reality (1968–1973). In Karle, C. (Ed.), *CEREN, an unfinished project. 50 years later* (pp. 23–33). Ediciones FEUC.

Working Papers

- **Deneken, M.**, & Biehl, A. The Survey Mission: Foreign Patronage, Catholic Networks and the Politicisation of the Social Sciences at Chile’s Catholic University, 1955–1973.
- **Deneken, M.**, Cárdenas Castro, J. C., Maltrain Silva, V., & Iglesias Vásquez, M. Autonomy under Tutelage: Militancy, Freemasonry and the Refoundation of Sociology at the University of Concepción (1990–1999).
- **Deneken, M.**, & Díaz, F. Normative opening and failed containment: Social uprising, state of exception, and justification of violence among Indigenous and non-Indigenous people in Chile (2018–2023).
- **Deneken, M.**, Navarrete, C., & Parada-Contzen, M. Fragmented right and shared enemy: Social media during the presidential election in Chile.

Other Publications & Reports

- Gerber, M. M., Moya, C., **Deneken, M.**, & Cantillán, R. (2025). Primer informe del Estudio Panel de Percepciones de Seguridad y Policías en Chile [Technical report].
- **Deneken, M.**, Valenzuela, E., & Murray, M. (2025, October 5). Indígenas y no indígenas frente al espejo. *Tercera Dosis*.
- González-Biedma, L., **Deneken, M.**, & González-Arias, J. (2025). Quali-quantitative data collection techniques and instruments: Analysis of socioeconomic determinants for university admission in Chile. *Revista Educación Iberoamericana: Investigación y Reflexión*, 1(1), 59–70.

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Founder

Methodo+Lab — Applied data science studio

Online

Jan. 2026 – Present

- Develop interactive web applications for data exploration and public communication of research.
- Process and analyze large-scale datasets in education, music, and culture; apply machine learning

methods to social and behavioral data.

Research Assistant

Santiago, Chile

Observatory of Violence and Social Legitimacy (OLES)

Jan. 2024 – Present

- Core team member of the *Longitudinal Study of Perceptions and Security (ELSEP)*; manage survey documentation and research data in [Harvard Dataverse](#).
- Design and maintain large-scale research databases supporting longitudinal survey operations and fully reproducible analysis.
- Built automated web-scraping pipelines covering national newspapers to construct longitudinal corpora for computational text analysis.

Coordinator & Quantitative Studies Researcher

Santiago, Chile

Center for Intercultural and Indigenous Studies (CIIR)

Dec. 2022 – Nov. 2025

- Led technical coordination of Wave 4 of the *Longitudinal Survey on Intercultural Relations (ELRI)*, one of Chile's flagship panel studies; data curated in [Harvard Dataverse](#).
- Collaborated with UNDP-CIIR on policy briefs informing the Constitutional Council process.
- Coordinated and co-edited the book *Intercultural Change in Chile* (Editorial Catalonia, 2025).

Research Assistant

Santiago, Chile

FONDECYT Project — *The Right Wing in Dispute: Ideology and Tactics in Contemporary Chile*

Nov. 2024 – Sept. 2025

- Implemented large-scale web scraping of Chilean online newspapers (2016–2024) to build a longitudinal political news corpus.
- Applied natural language processing to analyze political discourse and ideological positioning.

Methodological Advisor

Santiago & Villarrica, Chile

PREATI — FONDEF IDeA I+D Project 21I10037

Jan. 2023 – Sept. 2024

- Co-developed measurement indicators of Indigenous tourism activity; coordinated the national PREATI survey and facilitated focus groups with Indigenous communities across territories.

Research Assistant

Santiago & Valparaíso, Chile

FONDECYT Project No. 11200900 — *Refounding Sociology in Chile*

Mar. 2021 – Oct. 2023

- Conducted in-depth interviews with key sociological actors, systematized archival materials, and contributed to peer-reviewed journal articles.

Principal Investigator

Concepción, Chile

VRID-UDEC Project 220.172.027 — *Trends in Suicide Mortality in Chile*

Oct. 2020 – May 2021

- Led an undergraduate-awarded research grant: prepared the national DEIS mortality database, performed statistical modeling of suicide trends, and produced visualizations for dissemination.

Research Assistant

Concepción, Chile

VRID-UDEC Project 218.058.009 — *Discussion on Education in Chile (2017–2018)*

Dec. 2018 – Dec. 2020

- Conducted archival research on educational policy debates and interviewed key stakeholders in Chilean higher education.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026

- **Deneken, M.** Elite family networks in Latin America: Evidence from Wikipedia genealogical data (19th–21st centuries). *COMPTExT 2026*.
- **Deneken, M.** (Re)configuraciones interculturales: A longitudinal analysis of Indigenous–non-Indigenous dynamics in Chile (2016–2023). Book presentation, *LASA 2026 Congress*.

2025

- Gerber, M. M., Figuereido, A., **Deneken, M.**, & Bahamondes, J. State violence and resistance: Police violence, human rights and anti-repression measures. *ISPP Annual Meeting*.
- **Deneken, M.**, Díaz, F., González, R., & Fuenzalida, D. A longitudinal examination of factors facilitating and hindering intergroup trust: Indigenous and non-Indigenous people in Chile (2016–2023). *ISPP Annual Meeting*.
- **Deneken, M.** A radiography of media coverage of the police in Chile: A longitudinal analysis of online press (2000–2024). Panel *Police legitimacy and the democratic process in Chile* (VIO–668), *LASA 2025 Congress*.

2024

- **Deneken, M.**, Díaz, F., González, R., & Fuenzalida, D. A longitudinal examination of factors facilitating and hindering intergroup trust. *La Triada Conference — Latin American Congress of Social Sciences and Government*.
- Cárdenas, J. C., **Deneken, M.**, & Maltrain, V. Sociology in post-dictatorship Chile. *XII Chilean Sociology Congress, Universidad Diego Portales*.

2019 – 2023

- Cárdenas, J. C., **Deneken, M.**, & Maltrain, V. (2023). Refounding sociology in Chile (1990–2020). *Seminar on Chilean Sociology in Post-Dictatorship, U. de Valparaíso*.
- **Deneken, M.** (2022). Masonry, MAPU, and MIR: The refoundation and deployment of sociology at Universidad de Concepción (1991–2000). *XXXII ALAS Congress, UNAM, Mexico*.
- **Deneken, M.** (2022). Train to the South: The refoundation of sociology at Universidad de Concepción. *Chilean Sociology Congress, U. de Concepción*.
- **Deneken, M.**, & Cárdenas, J. (2021). The refoundation of sociology at Universidad de Concepción. *XIV Sociology Workshop, UBA, Argentina*.
- Montero, V., Santibáñez, C., Ortiz, C., & **Deneken, M.** (2021). Disagreement and polarization in higher education. *Research Colloquium, U. de Concepción*.
- Montero, V., & **Deneken, M.** (2019). The tension between free tuition and profit in the 2018 educational reform. *XXXII ALAS Congress, UNMSM, Peru*.
- **Deneken, M.** (2019). The Chilean right in the post-transition: The case of José Antonio Kast. *XXXII ALAS Congress, UNMSM, Peru*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor — Continuing Education

Center for Intercultural and Indigenous Studies (CIIR)

Santiago, Chile

2025

- *InteRcultural*: Computational techniques in social sciences applied to intercultural relations.

Teaching Assistant — Institute of Sociology

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

Santiago, Chile

2022 – 2024

- **Graduate**: Advanced Data Processing in R (SOL4001; 2022, 2023).
- **Undergraduate**: Qualitative Research Techniques (SOL133); Formation and Development of Latin American Culture (SOL127); Data Analysis II (SOL114).

Teaching Assistant — Sociology, Psychology & Political Science

Universidad de Concepción

Concepción, Chile

2018 – 2021

- Research Methodology; Latin American Sociology; Numerical Data Analysis I; Methods and Techniques of Qualitative Research; Social Bases of Human Behavior; Foundations of Social Theory.

ADVANCED TRAINING

- Research Internship**, Institute for Applied Computational Science (IACS), **Harvard University** — computational methods for social science; high-performance computing and applied machine learning. Jun. 2024
- Mixed Methods Summer School (EVMM)**, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile — advanced integration of qualitative and quantitative research designs. Jan. 2024
- Postgraduate Certificate in Advanced Data Processing and Analysis in R** (96 h), Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile — statistical programming with large-scale social survey data. 2021

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

- poesiaR** — Creator & maintainer. R package for importing, cleaning, and analyzing poetry corpora. matdknu.github.io/poesiaR
- familiaRes** — Creator & maintainer. R package for building and analyzing genealogical and family network data. deneken.me/familiaR-wiki

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Secretary General, UC Graduate Student Academic Council (**CADEPUC**) 2022 – 2023
- Master’s Student Representative, Institute of Sociology, UC 2022

MEDIA APPEARANCES

- Guest interview: *Intermedio Podcast*, Ep. 14 (CIIR) [video] 2025
- Cited as researcher on right-wing studies in *La Tercera* [article] 2025

MEMBERSHIPS, SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Memberships	COMTEXT Association (2026–); International Society of Political Psychology (2024–); International Sociological Association (2024–)
Programming & Data	R, Python, Stata; Git/GitHub, Zotero, $\LaTeX$
Methods	Natural language processing, longitudinal survey design, causal inference, web scraping, machine learning, mixed methods
Languages	Spanish (native); English (B2 — IELTS 6.5)

REFERENCES

Monica Gerber PhD in Social Research, LSE School of Government, P. Universidad Católica de Chile	Roberto González PhD in Psychology, University of Kent School of Psychology, P. Universidad Católica de Chile
Mauricio Bucca PhD in Sociology, Cornell University Institute of Sociology, P. Universidad Católica de Chile	Carlos Navarrete PhD in Computer Science, University of Toulouse Faculty of Engineering, Universidad de Concepción